Text 1

第 1 段

People often complain that plastics are too durable. Water bottles, shopping bags, and other trash litter the planet, from Mount Everest to the Mariana Trench, because plastics are everywhere and don't break down easily. But some plastic materials change over time. They crack and frizzle. They "weep" out additives. They melt into sludge. All of which creates huge headaches for institutions, such as museums, trying to preserve culturally important objects. The variety of plastic objects at risk is dizzying: early radios, avant-garde sculptures, celluloid animation stills from Disney films, the first artificial heart.

直译：人们常抱怨塑料太耐久。从珠穆朗玛峰到马里亚纳海沟，水瓶、购物袋和其他垃圾散落在地球各处，因为塑料无处不在，而且不易分解。但有些塑料材料会随时间发生变化：它们开裂、卷曲，渗出添加剂，融化成泥状物。所有这些，都给博物馆等试图保存重要文化物件的机构带来巨大麻烦。面临风险的塑料物品种类多得令人眼花缭乱：早期收音机、先锋派雕塑、迪士尼电影的赛璐珞动画画片，以及第一颗人造心脏。

第 2 段

Certain artifacts are especially vulnerable because some pioneers in plastic art didn't always know how to mix ingredients properly, says Thea van Oosten, a polymer chemist who, until retiring a few years ago, worked for decades at the Cultural Heritage Agency of the Netherlands. "It's like baking a cake: If you don't have exact amounts, it goes wrong," she says. "The object you make is already a time bomb."

直译：聚合物化学家西娅·范奥斯滕说，某些制品特别脆弱，因为一些塑料艺术先驱并不总是知道如何恰当混合原料。她在几年前退休之前，曾在荷兰文化遗产局工作数十年。她说："这就像烤蛋糕，如果用量不精确，就会出错。你做出来的东西，已经是一颗定时炸弹。"

第 3 段

And sometimes, it's not the artist's fault. In the 1960s, the Italian artist Piero Gilardi began to create hundreds of bright, colorful foam pieces. Those pieces included small beds of roses and other items as well as a few dozen "nature carpets" —large rectangles decorated with foam pumpkins, cabbages, and watermelons. He wanted viewers to walk around on the carpets-which meant they had to be durable.

直译：而有时，这并不是艺术家的过错。二十世纪六十年代，意大利艺术家皮耶罗·吉拉尔迪开始创作数百件鲜艳多彩的泡沫作品。这些作品包括小片玫瑰花圃及其他物品，还有几十幅"自然地毯"——用泡沫南瓜、卷心菜和西瓜装饰的大型长方形作品。他希望观众在地毯上走动，这就意味着它们必须耐用。

第 4 段

Unfortunately, the polyurethane foam he used is inherently unstable. It's especially vulnerable to light damage, and by the mid-1990s, Gilardi's pumpkins, roses, and other figures were splitting and crumbling. Museums locked some of them away in the dark.

直译：不幸的是，他使用的聚氨酯泡沫本身就不稳定。它特别容易受到光照损害，到二十世纪九十年代中期，吉拉尔迪的南瓜、玫瑰及其他造型已开始开裂、碎裂。博物馆把其中一些锁存于黑暗处。

第 5 段

So van Oosten and her colleagues worked to preserve Gilardi's sculptures. They infused some with stabilizing and consolidating chemicals. Van Oosten calls those chemicals "sunscreens" because their goal was to prevent further light damage and rebuild worn polymer fibers. She is proud that several sculptures have even gone on display again, albeit sometimes beneath protective cases.

直译：于是，范奥斯滕和同事着手保存吉拉尔迪的雕塑。他们向其中一些作品渗入具有稳定和加固作用的化学物质。范奥斯滕把这些化学物质称为“防晒霜”，因为它们的目标是防止进一步的光照损害，并重建已磨损的聚合物纤维。她感到自豪的是，有几件雕塑甚至重新展出了，尽管有时放在保护罩下。

第 6 段

Despite success stories like van Oosten's, preservation of plastics will likely get harder. Old objects continue to deteriorate. Worse, biodegradable plastics, designed to disintegrate, are increasingly common.

直译：尽管有范奥斯滕这样的成功案例，保存塑料制品很可能仍将变得更加困难。旧物件持续劣化。更糟的是，被设计成会分解的可生物降解塑料正变得越来越常见。

第 7 段

And more is at stake here than individual objects. Joana Lia Ferreira, an assistant professor of conservation and restoration at the NOVA School of Science and Technology, notes that archaeologists first defined the great material ages of human history- Stone Age, Iron Age, and so on-after examining artifacts in museums. We now live in an age of plastic, she says, "and what we decide to collect today, what we decide to preserve...will have a strong impact on how in the future we'll be seen."

直译：而且，这里受到威胁的不只是单个物件。新里斯本大学科学技术学院保护与修复助理教授若安娜·莉娅·费雷拉指出，考古学家最初是在考察博物馆中的制品之后，才界定出人类历史上以材料命名的重大时代，例如石器时代、铁器时代等等。她说，我们现在生活在塑料时代，“而我们今天决定收集什么、保存什么……将深刻影响未来人们如何看待我们。”

Text 2

第 1 段

As the latest crop of students pen their undergraduate application form and weigh up their options, it may be worth considering just how the point, purpose and value of a degree has changed and what Generation Z need to consider as they start the third stage of their educational journey.

直译：当最新一批学生填写本科入学申请表、权衡选择时，也许值得思考一下：学位的意义、目的与价值究竟发生了怎样的变化，以及 Z 世代在开启第三阶段教育旅程时，需要考虑些什么。

第 2 段

Millennials were told that if you did well in school, got a decent degree, you would be set up for life. But that promise has been found wanting. As degrees became universal, they became devalued. Education was no longer a secure route of social mobility. Today, 28 per cent of graduates in the UK are in non-graduate roles, a percentage which is double the average among the OECD countries.

直译：千禧一代曾被告知，如果你在学校表现好，获得一个不错的学位，你的一生就有保障了。但事实证明，这个承诺并不充分可靠。随着学位普及，其价值也贬低了。教育不再是一条稳妥的社会流动路径。如今，英国百分之二十八的大学毕业生从事不要求大学学历的工作，这一比例是经合组织国家平均值的两倍。

第 3 段

This is not to say that there is no point in getting a degree, but rather stress that a degree is not for everyone, that the switch from classroom to lecture hall is not an inevitable one and that other options are available.

直译：这并不是说取得学位毫无意义，而是要强调：学位并不适合每一个人，从中学教室走进大学讲堂并不是必然的道路，还有其他选择可走。

第 4 段

Thankfully, there are signs that this is already happening, with Generation Z seeking to learn from their millennial predecessors, even if parents and teachers tend to be still set in the degree mindset. Employers have long seen the advantages of hiring school leavers who often prove themselves to be more committed and loyal employees than graduates. Many too are seeing the advantages of scrapping a degree requirement for certain roles.

直译：值得庆幸的是，有迹象表明，这种变化已经在发生。Z 世代正试图从千禧一代前辈那里吸取经验，尽管父母和教师往往仍固守学位思维。雇主早已看到雇用中学毕业后直接就业者的好处，这些人往往证明自己比大学毕业生更敬业、更忠诚。许多雇主也开始看到，取消某些岗位学位要求的好处。

第 5 段

For those for whom a degree is the desired route, consider that this may well be the first of many. In this age of generalists, it pays to have specific knowledge or skills. Postgraduates now earn 40 per cent more than graduates. When more and more of us have a degree, it makes sense to have two.

直译：对于那些把攻读学位视为理想路径的人，请考虑：这很可能只是你将取得的多个学位中的第一个。在这个通才的时代，拥有专门知识或技能是有回报的。如今，研究生学历者的收入比本科毕业生高百分之四十。当我们之中越来越多人拥有一个学位时，拥有两个学位就显得合理。

第 6 段

It is unlikely that Generation Z will be done with education at 18 or 21; they will need to be constantly up-skilling throughout their career to stay employable. It has been estimated that this generation, due to the pressures of technology, the wish for personal fulfilment and desire for diversity, will work for 17 different employers over the course of their working life and have five different careers. Education, and not just knowledge gained on campus, will be a core part of Generation Z's career trajectory.

直译：Z 世代不太可能在十八岁或二十一岁时结束教育；他们需要在整个职业生涯中不断提升技能，以保持就业能力。据估计，由于技术压力、对个人成就感的追求，以及对多样性的渴望，这一代人在整个工作生涯中将为十七个不同雇主工作，并从事五种不同职业。教育，而不仅是在校园获得的知识，将成为 Z 世代职业轨迹的核心部分。

第 7 段

Older generations often talk about their degree in the present and personal tense: 'I am a geographer' or 'I am a classicist'. Their sons or daughters would never say such a thing; it's as if they already know that their degree won't define them in the same way.

直译：老一辈谈起自己的学位时，常采用现在时并将其作为个人身份："我是地理学者"，或"我是古典学者"。他们的儿女绝不会这样说；仿佛他们已经知道，自己的学位不会以同样方式定义自己。

Text 3

第 1 段

Enlightening, challenging, stimulating, fun. These were some of the words that Nature readers used to describe their experiences of art-science collaborations in a series of articles on partnerships between artists and researchers. Nearly 40% of the roughly 350 people who responded to an accompanying poll said they had collaborated with artists; and almost all said they would consider doing so in future.

直译：富有启发性、具有挑战性、激发思考、有趣。在一系列讨论艺术家与研究者合作关系的文章中，《自然》的读者用这些词语描述他们参与艺术与科学合作的经历。对配套调查作出回应的约三百五十人中，接近百分之四十表示自己曾与艺术家合作；而几乎所有人都说，未来会考虑这样做。

第 2 段

Such an encouraging result is not surprising. Scientists are increasingly seeking out visual artists to help them communicate their work to new audiences. “Artists help scientists reach a broader audience and make emotional connections that enhance learning,” one respondent said.

直译：这样令人鼓舞的结果并不意外。科学家越来越积极地寻找视觉艺术家，帮助他们向新的受众传达自己的工作。一位受访者说：“ 艺术家帮助科学家接触更广泛的受众，建立能够促进学习的情感联系。”

第 3 段

One example of how artists and scientists have together rocked the senses came last month when the Sydney Symphony Orchestra performed a reworked version of Antonio Vivaldi’s The Four Seasons. They reimagined the 300-year-old score by injecting the latest climate prediction data for each season-provided by Monash University’s Climate Change Communication Research Hub. The performance was a creative call to action ahead of November’s United Nations Climate Change Conference in Glasgow, UK.

直译：艺术家与科学家共同震撼感官的一个例子，出现在上个月：悉尼交响乐团演奏了安东尼奥·维瓦尔第《四季》的重新改编版。他们把莫纳什大学气候变化传播研究中心提供的各季节最新气候预测数据融入其中，重新构想了这部已有三百年历史的乐谱。这场演出，是在十一月于英国格拉斯哥举行的联合国气候变化大会之前，以创造性的方式呼吁人们采取行动。

第 4 段

But a genuine partnership must be a two-way street. Fewer artists than scientists responded to the Nature poll; however, several respondents noted that artists do not simply assist scientists with their communication requirements. Nor should their work be considered only as an object of study. The alliances are most valuable when scientists and artists have a shared stake in a project, are able to jointly design it and can critique each other’s work. Such an approach can both prompt new research as well as result in powerful art.

直译：但真正的伙伴关系必须是双向的。回应《自然》调查的艺术家少于科学家；不过，多位受访者指出，艺术家并不只是帮助科学家完成传播需求，他们的作品也不应仅被视为研究对象。当科学家与艺术家对项目有共同投入、能够共同设计项目，并能相互评论彼此的工作时，这种联盟最有价值。这样的方式既能促成新研究，也能产生富有力量的艺术作品。

第 5 段

More than half a century ago, the Massachusetts Institute of Technology opened its Center for Advanced Visual Studies (CAVS) to explore the role of technology in culture. The founders deliberately focused their projects around light—hence the 'visual studies' in the name. Light was something that both artists and scientists had an interest in, and therefore could form the basis of collaboration. As science and technology progressed, and divided into more sub-disciplines, the centre was simultaneously looking to a time when leading researchers could also be artists, writers and poets, and vice versa.

直译：半个多世纪以前，麻省理工学院设立高级视觉研究中心（CAVS），探索技术在文化中的作用。创办者有意把项目集中在光上，因此名称中出现了“视觉研究”。光是艺术家和科学家都感兴趣的事物，因而可以构成合作的基础。随着科学技术不断发展并划分为更多分支学科，该中心同时也在期待一个时代：领先的研究者也可以是艺术家、作家和诗人，反之亦然。

第 6 段

Nature's poll findings suggest that this trend is as strong as ever, but, to make a collaboration work, both sides need to invest time, and embrace surprise and challenge. The reach of art-science tie-ups needs to go beyond the necessary purpose of research communication, and participants must not fall into the trap of stereotyping each other. Artists and scientists alike are immersed in discovery and invention, and challenge and critique are core to both, too.

直译：《自然》的调查结果表明，这一趋势一如既往地强劲。但是，要使合作奏效，双方都需要投入时间，并接纳意外和挑战。艺术与科学合作的范围，需要超越科研传播这一必要目的，而参与者不能陷入相互刻板看待的陷阱。艺术家与科学家都沉浸于发现和创造之中，挑战与批评同样都是两者的核心。

Text 4

第 1 段

The personal grievance provisions of New Zealand's Employment Relations Act 2000 (ERA) prevent an employer from firing an employee without good cause. Instead, dismissals must be justified. Employers must both show cause and act in a procedurally fair way.

直译：新西兰《二〇〇〇年雇佣关系法》（ERA）中的个人申诉条款，禁止雇主在没有正当理由的情况下解雇员工。也就是说，解雇必须有合理依据。雇主既必须说明理由，也必须以程序公正的方式行事。

第 2 段

Personal grievance procedures were designed to guard the jobs of ordinary workers from "unjustified dismissals". The premise was that the common law of contract lacked sufficient safeguards for workers against arbitrary conduct by management. Long gone are the days when a boss could simply give an employee contractual notice.

直译：个人申诉程序旨在保护普通劳动者的岗位，使其免遭“无正当理由的解雇”。其前提是，普通法中的合同规则不足以保护劳动者免受管理层任意行为的侵害。老板只需按合同规定发出通知就能解雇员工的日子，早已过去。

第 3 段

But these provisions create difficulties for businesses when applied to highly paid managers and executives. As countless boards and business owners will attest, constraining firms from firing poorly performing, high-earning managers is a handbrake on boosting productivity and overall performance. The difference between C-grade and A-grade managers may very well be the difference between business success or failure. Between preserving the jobs of ordinary workers or losing them. Yet mediocrity is no longer enough to justify a dismissal.

直译：但是，当这些条款适用于高薪经理和高管时，就会给企业带来困难。无数董事会和企业主都可以证明：限制公司解雇表现不佳、收入很高的经理，会成为提高生产率和整体绩效的阻碍。三流经理与一流经理之间的差别，很可能就是企业成败之间的差别，也可能就是保住普通劳动者岗位与失去这些岗位之间的差别。然而，平庸已经不再足以成为解雇的正当理由。

第 4 段

Consequently-and paradoxically-laws introduced to protect the jobs of ordinary workers may be placing those jobs at risk.

直译：因此，颇具悖论意味的是，那些为保护普通劳动者岗位而引入的法律，可能正在把这些岗位置于风险之中。

第 5 段

If not placing jobs at risk, to the extent employment protection laws constrain business owners from dismissing underperforming managers, those laws act as a constraint on firm productivity and therefore on workers' wages. Indeed, in "An International Perspective on New Zealand's Productivity Paradox" (2014), the Productivity Commission singled out the low quality of managerial capabilities as a cause of the country's poor productivity growth record.

直译：即使这些法律没有使岗位面临风险，只要就业保护法限制企业主解雇业绩不佳的经理，它们就会限制企业生产率，从而限制劳动者工资。事实上，生产率委员会在二〇一四年的《从国际视角看新西兰生产率悖论》中，特别指出，管理能力低下是该国生产率增长表现不佳的一个原因。

第 6 段

Nor are highly paid managers themselves immune from the harm caused by the ERA'S unjustified dismissal procedures. Because employment protection laws make it costlier to fire an employee, employers are more cautious about hiring new staff. This makes it harder for the marginal manager to gain employment. And firms pay staff less because firms carry the burden of the employment arrangement going wrong.

直译：高薪经理自己也无法免受 ERA 中有关无正当理由解雇程序所造成的伤害。由于就业保护法提高了解雇员工的成本，雇主在招聘新员工时更加谨慎。这使处于录用边缘的经理更难找到工作。而且，由于企业承担着雇佣安排出问题的风险负担，它们支付给员工的工资也更低。

第 7 段

Society also suffers from excessive employment protections. Stringent job dismissal regulations adversely affect productivity growth and hamper both prosperity and overall well-being.

直译：过度就业保护也会使社会受损。严格的解雇规定会对生产率增长产生不利影响，并妨碍繁荣及整体福祉。

第 8 段

Across the Tasman Sea, Australia deals with the unjustified dismissal paradox by excluding employees earning above a specified "high-income threshold" from the protection of its unfair dismissal laws. In New Zealand, a 2016 private members' Bill tried to permit firms and high-income employees to contract out of the unjustified dismissal regime. However, the mechanisms proposed were unwieldy and the Bill was voted down following the change in government later that year.

直译：在塔斯曼海的另一边，澳大利亚通过把收入高于规定 " 高收入门槛 " 的员工排除在不公平解雇法的保护之外，处理这一无正当理由解雇的悖论。在新西兰，一项二〇一六年的议员个人法案曾试图允许企业与高收入员工通过合同约定，不受该无正当理由解雇制度的约束。然而，所提出的机制过于繁复难行，而且在当年稍后政府更替之后，这项法案被投票否决。